

The Hymn to the United Nations is an anthem composed to mark the 26th anniversary of the founding of the United Nations.

History

On the request of then United Nations Secretary-General U Thant, Hymn to the United Nations was performed on the occasion of its 26th anniversary, on 24 October 1971, by Pau Casals, the lyrics to which were penned by the poet W. H. Auden.

Thant first approached Casals, who was a personal friend, looking to create a hymn to peace and hoping for the song to be based on the preamble of the Charter of the United Nations. Thant later commissioned Auden to write the poem after Casals requested one to set to music. Auden completed his work in three days time. The finished work, scored for chorus and orchestra, takes approximately seven minutes to perform. The piece was sung by the Manhattan School of Music Chorale. However, there were never any plans to adopt the song as the organization's official anthem.

Lyrics

See also

Flag of the United Nations

Anthems of international organizations

Earth anthem

References

External links

Hymn to the United Nations – Instrumental version

Hymn to the United Nations – Vocal version